

EUROPEAN COURT OF HUMAN RIGHTS
COUR EUROPÉENNE DES DROITS DE L'HOMME

FOURTH SECTION

CASE OF BISS AND OTHERS v. RUSSIA

(Applications nos. 51079/21 and 29 others –
see appended list)

JUDGMENT

STRASBOURG

14 May 2024

This judgment is final but it may be subject to editorial revision.



In the case of Biss and Others v. Russia,

The European Court of Human Rights (Fourth Section), sitting as a Committee composed of:

Branko Lubarda*, President*,
Armen Harutyunyan,
Ana Maria Guerra Martins*, judges*,
and Viktoriya Maradudina, *Acting Deputy Section Registrar,*

Having deliberated in private on 11 April 2024,

Delivers the following judgment, which was adopted on that date:

PROCEDURE

1. The case originated in applications against Russia lodged with the Court under Article 34 of the Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms ("the Convention") on the various dates indicated in the appended table.

2. The applicants were represented by the Memorial Human Rights Centre in Moscow.

3. The Russian Government ("the Government") were given notice of the applications.

THE FACTS

4. The list of applicants and the relevant details of the applications are set out in the appended table.

5. The applicants complained of the disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of nationwide protests in support of the jailed opposition leader, Aleksey Navalnyy. They also raised other complaints under the provisions of the Convention.

THE LAW

I. JOINDER OF THE APPLICATIONS

6. Having regard to the similar subject matter of the applications, the Court finds it appropriate to examine them jointly in a single judgment.

II. JURISDICTION

7. The Court observes that the facts giving rise to the alleged violations of the Convention occurred prior to 16 September 2022, the date on which the Russian Federation ceased to be a party to the Convention. The Court therefore decides that it has jurisdiction to examine the present applications

(see *Fedotova and Others v. Russia* [GC], nos. 40792/10 and 2 others, §§ 68-73, 17 January 2023).

III. ALLEGED VIOLATION OF ARTICLE 11 OF THE CONVENTION

8. The applicants complained principally of disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies, namely their arrest in relation to the dispersal of these assemblies and their conviction for administrative offences. They relied, expressly or in substance, on Article 11 of the Convention.

9. The Court refers to the principles established in its case-law regarding freedom of assembly (see *Kudrevičius and Others v. Lithuania* [GC], no. 37553/05, ECHR 2015, with further references) and proportionality of interference with it (see *Oya Ataman v. Turkey*, no. 74552/01, ECHR 2006-XIV, and *Hyde Park and Others v. Moldova*, no. 33482/06, 31 March 2009).

10. In the leading cases of *Frumkin v. Russia,* no. 74568/12, ECHR 2016 (extracts), *Navalnyy and Yashin v. Russia,* no. 76204/11, 4 December 2014 and *Kasparov and Others v. Russia,* no. 21613/07, 3 October 2013, the Court already found a violation in respect of issues similar to those in the present case.

11. Having examined all the material submitted to it, the Court has not found any fact or argument capable of persuading it to reach a different conclusion as to the admissibility and merits of these complaints. Having regard to its case-law on the subject, the Court considers that in the instant case the interferences with the applicants' freedom of assembly were not "necessary in a democratic society".

12. These complaints are therefore admissible and disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention.

IV. OTHER ALLEGED VIOLATIONS UNDER WELL-ESTABLISHED CASE-LAW

13. The applicants submitted other complaints which also raised issues under the Convention and its Protocols, given the relevant well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table). These complaints are not manifestly ill-founded within the meaning of Article 35 § 3 (a) of the Convention, nor are they inadmissible on any other ground. Accordingly, they must be declared admissible.

14. Having examined all the material before it, the Court concludes that these complaints also disclose violations of the Convention and its Protocols in the light of its findings in *Butkevich v. Russia*, no. 5865/07, §§ 63-65, 13 February 2018, *Tsvetkova and Others v. Russia*, nos. 54381/08 and 5 others, §§ 115-31, 10 April 2018, and *Korneyeva v. Russia*,

no. 72051/17, §§ 34-36, 8 October 2019, as to various aspects of unlawful deprivation of liberty of organisers or participants of public assemblies; *Karelin v. Russia*, no. 926/08, §§ 58-85, 20 September 2016, concerning the absence of a prosecuting party in the proceedings under the Code of Administrative Offences (the CAO); and *Martynyuk v. Russia*, no. 13764/15, §§ 38-42, 8 October 2019, relating to the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal against the sentence of administrative detention.

V. REMAINING COMPLAINTS

15. Some applicants raised further additional complaints under Article 6 of the Convention concerning other aspects of fairness of the administrative-offence proceedings. In view of the findings in paragraphs 11 and 13 above, the Court considers that there is no need to deal separately with these remaining complaints.

VI. APPLICATION OF ARTICLE 41 OF THE CONVENTION

16. Regard being had to the documents in its possession and to its case-law (see in particular *Navalnyy and Others v. Russia* [Committee], nos. 25809/17 and 14 others, § 22, 4 October 2022), the Court finds it reasonable to award the sums indicated in the appended table.

FOR THESE REASONS, THE COURT, UNANIMOUSLY,

1. *Decides* to join the applications;

2. *Holds* that it has jurisdiction to deal with these applications as they relate to facts that took place before 16 September 2022;

3. *Declares* the complaints under Article 11 of the Convention and the other complaints under well-established case-law of the Court, as set out in the appended table, admissible, and *finds* that there is no need to examine separately the remaining complaints under Article 6 of the Convention;

4. *Holds* that these applications disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention;

5. *Holds* that there has been a violation of the Convention and the Protocols thereto as regards the other complaints raised under the well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table);

6. *Holds*

(a) that the respondent State is to pay the applicants, within three months, the amounts indicated in the appended table, to be converted into the currency of the respondent State at the rate applicable at the date of settlement;
(b) that from the expiry of the above-mentioned three months until settlement simple interest shall be payable on the above amounts at a rate equal to the marginal lending rate of the European Central Bank during the default period plus three percentage points.

Done in English, and notified in writing on 14 May 2024, pursuant to Rule 77 §§ 2 and 3 of the Rules of Court.

Viktoriya Maradudina	Branko Lubarda
Acting Deputy Registrar	President

APPENDIX

List of applications raising complaints under Article 11 of the Convention
(disproportionate measures against organisers and participants of public assemblies)

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative / criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
1.	51079/21 13/10/2021	**Ivan Pavlovich BISS** 1987	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 11/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence report from 6.30 p.m. until 10 p.m. on 23/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
2.	51084/21 13/10/2021	**Anton Andreyevich KUKARKIN** 1996	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Yekaterinburg 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	20 hours of community work	Sverdlovsk Regional Court 14/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence report from 4.50 p.m. until 8 p.m. on 23/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
3.	51088/21 13/10/2021	**Yegor Gennadyevich ZELENETSKIY** 1996	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 7 days	Moscow City Court 11/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 1.20 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 3.30 p.m. on 01/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
4.	51090/21 13/10/2021	**Kseniya Vladimirovna MUKHLYNINA** 1988	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 14/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 5.10 p.m. until 9 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative / criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
5.	51107/21 13/10/2021	**Mikhail Vladimirovich CHUVAKIN** 1971	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 14/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 2.15 p.m. on 23/01/2021 until 12.02 a.m. on 24/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
6.	51110/21 13/10/2021	**Anzhelika Andreyevna PYANTKOVSKAYA** 1986	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Pskov 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Pskov Regional Court 26/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence report from 12.15 p.m. until 3.35 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
7.	51231/21 08/10/2021	**Nikita Ivanovich MAKSHEV** 1999	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Saransk 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 5,000	Supreme Court of the Mordovia Republic 11/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 8 p.m. on 21/04/2021 until 2.30 a.m. on 22/04/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
8.	51386/21 08/10/2021	**Konstantin Viktorovich NAGULO** 1981	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 12/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 4.50 p.m. on 23/01/2021 until 1 a.m. on 24/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
9.	51398/21 08/10/2021	**Azamat Aslanovich BAGOV** 1999	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 01/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 10.55 p.m. on 02/02/2021 until 6.10 a.m. on 03/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000

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10.	51444/21 06/10/2021	**Viktor Vyacheslavovich ZHABIN** 1963	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 08/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence report from 3 p.m. until 7 p.m. on 23/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
11.	53522/21 19/10/2021	**Natalya Ivanovna ZHELYAPOVA** 1994	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 8 days	Moscow City Court 22/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 11.20 a.m. on 02/02/2021 until 4.50 p.m. on 03/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000
12.	53884/21 22/10/2021	**Yuriy Mikhaylovich DOBROKHOTOV** 1998	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 2 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 02/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 8.30 p.m. on 21/04/2021 until 6 p.m. on 22/04/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
13.	53889/21 22/10/2021	**Anton Igorevich SHALIMOV** 1985	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Samara 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Samara Regional Court 20/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence report from 3 p.m. until 6 p.m. on 23/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
14.	53932/21 22/10/2021	**Aleksandr Vladimirovich SHCHEMELEV** 1986	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Perm 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Perm Regional Court 28/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 1.30 p.m. until 9.30 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative / criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
15.	53968/21 22/10/2021	**Aleksandr Ilyich VOYNOV** 2002	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 13/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 10.30 a.m. until 5.30 p.m. on 02/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
16.	53981/21 22/10/2021	**Daniil Igorevich ATMANOV** 1999	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 11/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 10.46 a.m. until 5.22 p.m. on 02/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
17.	53984/21 22/10/2021	**Aleksandr Olegovich SIDELNIKOV** 1990	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 5,000	Moscow City Court 26/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 1.20 p.m. until 8.10 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
18.	53994/21 22/10/2021	**Galina Leonidovna GRIBUTSKAYA** 1960	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Vologda 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Vologda Regional Court 17/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 1 p.m. until 5 p.m. on 31/01/2021.	4,000
19.	53996/21 05/10/2021	**Pavel Aleksandrovich BAYBARA** 1993	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 03/02/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 06/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 12.01 a.m. until 3 p.m. on 03/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	5,000

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20.	54107/21 19/10/2021	**Lyudmila Ivanovna KHOTLUBEY** 1948	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 27/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 12.15 p.m. until 8.30 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
21.	54207/21 19/10/2021	**Sergey Anatolyevich SAKHANOV** 1998	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 19/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 5.45 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 5.30 a.m. on 01/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
22.	54227/21 19/10/2021	**Agnessa Aleksandrovna BUKOVSKAYA** 1980	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 26/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 3.27 p.m. until 10.35 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
23.	54301/21 21/10/2021	**Yevgeniy Andreyevich BARANCHIKOV** 1993	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Voronezh 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Voronezh Regional Court 21/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 2.30 p.m. until 7.35 p.m. on 31/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
24.	54310/21 21/10/2021	**Petr Anatolyevich GUTYNIN** 1987	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 03/08/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 1.45 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 3.45 a.m. 01/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000

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25.	54359/21 19/10/2021	**Aleksandr Romanovich POZLEVICH** 1996	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 22/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 11.10 p.m. on 02/02/2021 until 3 p.m. on 03/02/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
26.	54373/21 19/10/2021	**Aleksandr Mikhaylovich TROPIN** 1992	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 20/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 4.30 p.m. on 23/01/2021 until 01.30 a.m. on 24/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
27.	54450/21 27/10/2021	**Ralina Rustemovna SHIGABIYEVA** 1992	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 26/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 8.40 p.m. on 21/04/2021 until 8.10 p.m. on 22/04/2021.	4,000
28.	54745/21 18/10/2021	**Yuliya Sergeyevna ELTSOVA** 1995	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Sochi 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Krasnodar Regional Court 21/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence report from 4.30 p.m. until 10 p.m. on 23/01/2021; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings.	4,000
29.	54847/21 28/10/2021	**Albert Ramilevich YAPPAROV** 2001	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 05/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 2.40 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 7 p.m. on 01/02/2021.	4,000

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30.	55437/21 29/10/2021	**Andrey Andreyevich SHEMSHURA** 1989	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Rostov-on-Don 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 7 days	Rostov Regional Court 29/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO.	5,000

[1] Plus any tax that may be chargeable to the applicants.